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Global Round-Up: National AI Policies



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As artificial intelligence (AI) continues to have a transformative impact on the global stage, many countries are pursuing a balance between innovation and regulation. Thus, countries worldwide are attempting to design and implement AI governance policies commensurate with this technology's rapid and widespread development. These efforts include comprehensive legislation, national AI strategies and policies, sector-specific regulation, and voluntary guidelines. This landscape identifies the relevant legislative or policy developments for selected countries in each jurisdiction.

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Europe

European Union (EU)

The European Union introduced one of the first comprehensive regulatory frameworks applicable to AI systems, ranging from fundamental rights to product safety, privacy and copyright. The EU's approach to AI is primarily covered under the [EU AI Act](#), which aims to create the world's first legal framework specifically for AI.

The EU AI Act follows a [risk-based approach](#), categorizing AI systems into risk levels. The highest level of risk is "Unacceptable Risk", for which the Act bans AI applications that threaten safety and fundamental rights, such as social scoring or deceptive behavioral manipulation. The next level is "High-Risk", for which the Act requires strict regulation and includes a broad range of systems used in areas like education, employment, justice, healthcare or law enforcement. The third level is "Limited Risk", for which the Act imposes transparency requirements such as disclosing to consumers that they are interacting with AI. Finally, there is a Minimal Risk level, and the Act imposes only a few requirements for those systems.



Austria

In August 2021, the Austrian Government presented the national AI strategy, [Artificial Intelligence Mission Austria 2030](#) (AIM AT 2030). The strategy lays out three objectives: broad use of AI for the common good, positioning Austria as a location for innovation in fields of strength, and securing Austria's competitiveness through the development and use of AI. In 2024, the Austrian government [updated](#) their telecommunications and media laws to establish an AI service center within the Regulatory Authority for Broadcasting and Telecommunications (RTR) to act as a public point of contact and to help implement the EU AI Act.



Belgium

Belgium approved the [National Convergence Plan on AI](#) in October 2022.

The plan establishes a governing board and establishes nine common objectives: 1) Promoting trustworthy AI; 2) Guaranteeing cybersecurity; 3) Strengthening the competitiveness and the attractiveness of Belgium through AI; 4) Developing a data-driven economy and a high-performance infrastructure; 5) Centralizing AI in healthcare; 6) Using AI for sustainable mobility; 7) Protecting the environment; 8) Providing life-long learning opportunities; 9) Offering citizens better service and protection.

On September 19, 2024, the Belgian Data Protection Authority [released](#) guidelines explaining the need for AI systems to adhere to data protection principles. It also included specific requirements for high-risk AI systems.



Czech Republic

The Czech Republic released a [National Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#) (NAIS) in May 2019 to support the development and use of AI. The NAIS sets out a framework of seven priority objectives to support AI development in the academic, public and private sectors, mutual cooperation and international engagement.

To meet the demands of rapid technological developments, the Ministry of Industry and Trade is preparing an update of the NAIS, which will determine priorities and goals in this area until 2030.



Denmark

On November 13th, 2024, Denmark [released](#) its framework for using AI in compliance with the EU AI Act. An alliance of the government and major Danish corporations developed the framework to create a best practices guide on how the public and private sectors should collaborate, deploy AI in society, and comply with both the AI Act and the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).

In 2019, the Danish Government established the [National AI Strategy](#). The strategy initially contained 24 initiatives for which 9.2 million Euros had been reserved for the period 2019-2027. The budget has since been reprioritized and lowered to 5 million Euros.



Estonia

Estonia first established an [AI policy](#) in 2019 but intended it to be a short-term strategy that would apply until 2021. In 2021, the Estonian Cabinet adopted a new [AI strategy](#) (2022-2023) as a continuation of its first. The new strategy was primarily concerned with human-centered and trustworthy AI, outlining specific actions that regulate the development in a trustworthy way. It also establishes civil liability related to AI.



Finland

Finland was one of the first countries to develop a [national AI policy](#), establishing target dates and allocating public funds in furtherance of AI business objectives in 2017. Since then, Finland has continued developing policy recommendations through its steering committee to keep up with its rapid digital expansion. In 2020, Finland established its [Artificial Intelligence 4.0 Programme](#) to increase digital investment and European cooperation, with a special focus on manufacturing and process industries, business services, and trade.



France

The French government launched the [National AI Strategy](#) as part of "France 2030." The National AI Strategy has two phases. The first phase aimed to provide France with competitive AI research capacities with a short-term focus on 2018-2022. The second phase aims to disseminate AI within the economy and to support development in priority areas from 2021-2025.

While France is not expected to adopt a national regulatory framework due to the EU AI Act, France does engage in sector-specific regulation. In addition, the French data protection agency created the [Artificial Intelligence Service](#) to address questions relating to the relationship between AI and data protection.



Germany

Germany published its original National AI Strategy in [2018](#) and updated it in [2020](#) and [2023](#). While the EU AI Act addressed many of their concerns, the German government has consistently emphasized the responsibility of AI hardware and software manufacturers and deployers, as well as the need to protect personal data and individual rights under the GDPR. The 2023 plan emphasized that future German policy must balance properly regulating AI and inhibiting innovation.

Hungary



The Hungarian Ministry of Innovation and Technology Government [released](#) a national AI strategy with goals set up to 2030, with the intention of reviewing the plan every two years. The government emphasized its intention to increase digitization efforts, raise the living standards of its citizens, and protect the environment. The ethical guidelines are being monitored by the [AI Coalition of Hungary](#), an independent oversight advisory body charged with offering technical guidance and collecting information from stakeholders.

In preparing to implement the EU AI Act, the Hungarian government adopted [Resolution 1301/2024 \(IX.30\)](#) which establishes a body supported by the Ministry of National Economy responsible for the AI Act implementation, which is [expected](#) to open by August 2025

Ireland



Ireland published the national AI strategy “[AI - Here for Good](#)” in 2021, which outlined a long-term AI approach. In 2023, the Minister of Trade Promotion, Digital and Company Regulation issued a [progress report](#) that celebrated strides in AI regulation and outlined specific future priorities. These priorities include influencing the regulation of AI abroad, supporting businesses and workers, finalizing guidelines for AI use in the public sector, and investigating what support the AI sector may need. In October 2024, Ireland [designated](#) nine national bodies to oversee ethical AI governance, in line with the EU AI Act.

Italy



The Italian government released the [National AI Strategy](#) with three key areas: attracting talent to develop an AI ecosystem, increasing funding for AI research, and encouraging the adoption of AI in the public and private sectors.

In addition, the highest administrative court in Italy [found](#) that algorithmic decision-making in administrative procedures must account for 1) transparency regarding the existence of an automated decision, 2) human involvement in the decision if the decision produces legal or significant effects on a person, and 3) adequate measures to ensure non-discrimination.

Lithuania



In 2019, the Ministry of Economy and Innovation released Lithuania's [National AI Strategy](#), which set an objective to advise the public sector on ethical AI regulation and implementation. It also focused on securing trust in AI regulations, facilitating transparency, and encouraging ethics by design. In 2022, an [Action Plan](#) for the development of AI was released, which focused on AI technology development in 2023 through 2026.

In addition, Lithuania [became one of the first](#) countries in the EU to create an AI sandbox to accelerate innovation. The Innovation Agency, the Communications Regulatory Authority, and the EU AI Act will be the primary sources of oversight in this pilot environment.

Luxembourg



The Luxembourg [Strategic Vision for Artificial Intelligence](#) was presented in 2019. The strategy has three goals: to establish the country as one of the most advanced digital societies, to foster a data-driven and sustainable economy, and to support human-centric AI development.

On December 23, 2024, Draft Law [No. 8476](#) was introduced to implement the provisions of the EU AI Act, which is currently pending approval by Luxembourg's Parliament.

Malta



"[Strategy and Vision for Artificial Intelligence in Malta 2030](#)" is Malta's National AI Strategy, adopted in 2019. It focuses on investment, resources, and attention to maximize AI's benefits and contributions to the global economy.

On June 1, 2022, Malta launched a [regulatory sandbox](#) for start-ups and small companies to test technological innovations, including those in AI.

Netherlands



On October 16, 2024, the Netherlands [adopted](#) a guide on European AI Regulation addressed to entrepreneurs and organizations involved in machine learning and AI development.

In January 2024, the Dutch government published a [Vision on Generative AI](#), which lays out the relevant laws, regulations, and policies that the government deems necessary for the beneficial use of Generative AI.



Norway

In 2020, the Norwegian government announced its [National AI Strategy](#). The strategy's objective is to outline policy actions that will maximize the opportunities that AI can create for Norwegian individuals, businesses, industry, and the public sector.



Portugal

Portugal released its policy "[AI Portugal 2030](#)" to promote research and innovation in AI for both the public and private sectors. Portugal identified specific actions to take, including inclusion and education, qualification and specialization, and research.

In 2021, the Portuguese government [took steps](#) to establish Technological Free Zones (ZLTs), which are regulatory sandboxes to promote the development and testing of new technologies including AI.



Russia

In March 2024, Russian President Vladimir Putin [updated](#) the country's national policy through the "Presidential Decree introducing amendments to the National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence Development in the Russian Federation up to 2030." This decree includes measures to update Russia's main AI objectives and metrics for AI adoption.

Russia's national strategy was [first adopted](#) in 2019 with the aim of increasing the development of AI in Russia and protecting national priorities.



Slovenia

The [National Programme on AI](#) (NpAI) was adopted in 2021 with the goal of becoming an advanced digital society. The NpAI lays out a plan for social and economic development that includes specific indicators, guidance on measuring progress, and instruments for implementation and financing.



Spain

Spain published a [Charter of Digital Rights](#) in 2021, establishing a set of non-binding principles and rights to inform AI use and development. In 2020, Spain also published a [National Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#). Then, in 2024, the [Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2024](#) was approved by the Council of Ministers which focuses on strengthening AI deployment, fostering responsible AI, and promoting language models in Spanish.

As part of Spain's development strategy, the country established an AI Sandbox through [Royal Decree 817/2023](#). This sandbox creates a controlled test environment to enable participants to implement high-risk AI systems.

The Spanish government has also approved [Royal Decree 729/2023](#), which regulates the incorporation of the Spanish Agency for the Supervision of Artificial Intelligence. The agency's activities will be focused on supervisory tasks, including inspection and sanctioning powers provided by the EU AI Act.



Sweden

In May 2018, Sweden issued the [National Approach to Artificial Intelligence](#). The central theme was ensuring sustainable AI, defined as ethical, safe, secure, reliable, and transparent.

In 2024, Sweden [appointed](#) an AI commission to develop proposals for promoting Sweden as a leading research, industrial, and welfare nation.



Switzerland

Switzerland's Federal Council has [instructed](#) the Federal Department of the Environment, Transport, Energy and Communications (DETEC) to identify potential AI regulatory approaches by the end of 2024. The council intends to issue a mandate for an AI regulatory proposal in 2025.

In the meantime, the Federal Council has [implemented](#) general guidelines to ensure the appropriate use of AI in the federal government. Other sector-specific AI regulations exist, such as regulations for AI in [medical devices](#) and [autonomous vehicles](#).



Ukraine

In October 2023, the Ukrainian government presented a [Roadmap for the Regulation of AI](#), which proposed a bottom-up approach separated into two phases. The first, which is estimated to take two to three years, prioritizes self-regulation by businesses. The second phase explained Ukraine's commitment to adopt a law similar to the EU AI Act.



United Kingdom

The United Kingdom has taken a non-statutory approach to AI regulation, favoring a principles-based approach that provides “critical adaptability.” The government's AI Regulation [White Paper](#), published in 2023, and the government's [written response](#) to feedback on the White Paper, published in 2024, indicate that the UK does have an intention to implement horizontal regulation of AI.

In February 2024, the government [asked](#) regulators whose work is impacted by AI to publish an update outlining their strategic approach to AI. The regulators' [responses](#) included their adherence to the White Paper's principles, plans of action, and actions already taken.

On January 13, 2025, the UK Labor government [launched](#) an AI action plan with the goal of boosting economic efficiency and growth. Provisions included dedicated AI growth zones, new infrastructure, and a National Data Library.

North America



Canada

Canada, like the EU, has focused on ethics and human rights in its approach to AI regulation.

Canada's [Directive on Automated Decision-Making](#) establishes standards for transparency and fairness, especially in government applications. These standards require the government to explain AI decisions that affect people's lives, such as automated loan approvals. Canadian policy emphasizes that AI systems should be accountable, allowing people to understand and challenge decisions made by AI.

Canada has also funded initiatives to use AI to address social issues, such as healthcare and environmental sustainability, through its [Pan-Canadian Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#).

Canada has sought to present its own model for AI oversight and regulation, through [Bill C-27](#) and the Artificial Intelligence and Data Act, which seeks to establish "common requirements, applicable across Canada, for the design, development and use" of AI systems. Artificial intelligence systems are defined with a broad brush as any technological system that, "autonomously or partly autonomously, processes data related to human activities through the use of a genetic algorithm, a neural network, machine learning or another technique in order to generate content or make decisions, recommendations or predictions." Many of its definitions are left opaque or undefined, leaving interpretations that could lead to disclosure of trade secrets, excessive punishments for innovators, and restrictions on services trade for online programs. "High-impact" AI systems are not defined in the bill, and are set aside for elucidation in future regulations, while also putting legal obligations on individuals or companies who "develop or make available for use the artificial intelligence system or manage its operation" to determine whether or not a system is "high-impact" or risk punishment of a fine.

Bill C-27 is still under consideration in the House of Commons, with over 200 amendments considered as part of the in-committee process. The proposed changes are substantial, and include: updates on key definitions, establishing seven classes of high-impact AI systems, clarifying obligations, and strengthening the powers of the AI and Data Commissioner.



Mexico

In 2018, Mexico adopted its [national AI agenda](#). The country identified Mexico's manufacturing-centric economy as an at-risk industry amid growing automation. The strategy sought to address these and other AI concerns through key areas, including governance, government, research and development, capacity, skills, data infrastructure, and ethical regulation. The National Artificial Intelligence Alliance, an independent body established by Congress, [oversees](#) the development of AI.

In January 2025, the Mexican government filed a [new AI bill](#) that imposes requirements on developers and deployers of AI systems, with stricter requirements for systems deemed "high-risk." These requirements include risk management strategies, impact assessments, and documentation standards.



United States

In contrast to the EU, the United States has taken a more hands-off approach to AI. The U.S. emphasizes innovation and economic growth. The Trump Administration has emphasized removing any requirements that hinder AI innovation.

In January, President Trump revoked Biden's Executive Order on Safe, Secure, and Trustworthy AI, and [issued](#) his own AI Executive Order entitled Removing Barriers to American Leadership in Artificial Intelligence. The order directs the Office of Management and Budget to overhaul its existing directive on AI to ensure guidelines that prevent AI development and deployment are removed.

For many years, the U.S. approach has largely been more tailored to sector-specific regulation. Each sector takes its own approach by acting through agency power. In some industries, such as healthcare or finance, regulations are more detailed due to the higher risk of harm. For example, the Food and Drug Administration (FDA) has issued a list of [approved AI-enabled medical devices](#). However, it is unclear if this approach will continue with the new administration.

South America



Argentina

In 2019, the Ministry of Science, Technology and Productive Innovation published the [National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence](#), which includes two priority initiatives: [Digital Agenda Argentina](#) and the National Strategy for Science, Technology, and Innovation, Argentina Innovates 2030.

Argentina's ten-year plan comes with the ultimate goal of positioning Argentina as a regional leader in AI. The country plans to leverage the technology to pursue development based on the UN's Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). The Ministry is focused on implementing AI to improve [judicial efficiency](#), transform the healthcare sector, and [incorporate AI into education](#).



Brazil

In April 2021, the Brazilian government adopted a national AI strategy, "[Estratégia Brasileira de Inteligência Artificial](#)," which sets out ways to remove barriers to innovation and increase collaboration among the government, private sector, and researchers. In December 2024, Brazil's proposed AI regulation Bill 2338/2023 [passed](#) the Senate and is now awaiting a vote in the House. The proposed framework mirrors the EU AI Act by taking a risk-based approach to AI.

In October 2023, Brazil's data protection authority (the ANPD) [established](#) a regulatory sandbox program for AI and data protection.



Chile

Chile's [National AI Policy](#) was published in 2021. It came with Chile's AI Action Plan, which combines around 70 priority tasks in areas such as education, product development, and talent management. In May 2024, The Ministry of Science, Technology, Knowledge, and Innovation introduced a [bill](#) to regulate AI with a risk-based approach, which is in front of the Chamber of Deputies.



Colombia

In February 2024, Colombia established the [AI Roadmap](#) to ensure AI's ethical and sustainable adoption. However, the roadmap does not provide concrete criteria or responsibilities for the ethical use of AI. In 2021, Colombia's data protection authority [launched](#) a regulatory sandbox so that AI developers and regulators could collaborate in creating 'privacy by design'.

The National Council for Economic and Social Policy (CONPES) developed [CONPES 3975](#) on National Policy for Digital Transformation and Artificial Intelligence, outlining Colombia's digital economic strategy. The document focuses on the strategic importance of AI when enhancing public services, fostering innovation in different industries, and improving the well-being of Colombian citizens.



Costa Rica

On October 24th, 2024, Costa Rica became the first country in Central America to adopt a policy dedicated to the responsible use of AI. The Ministry of Science, Innovation, Technology, and Telecommunications (MICITT) announced the [National Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#) (ENIA) 2024-2027.

The strategy creates a regulatory framework to oversee AI development and define its technical and ethical guidelines. It also highlights the importance of deploying 5G networks and establishing a National Center of Excellence in AI.



Dominican Republic

The Dominican Republic established the [National Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#) as part of its National Innovation Policy 2030, which aims to make the Dominican Republic a leader in using AI for economic and social development. The policy includes a [2030 Digital Agenda](#) and the [Innovation Policy \(PNI\)](#).



Jamaica

In February 2024, the Jamaican government [declared](#) its commitment to addressing risks posed by AI to democratic processes. The Minister for Skills and Digital Transformation expressed concern for AI-generated content like deepfakes as the country undergoes electoral milestones.

Jamaica established an [AI Task Force](#) in December 2023 with the goal of creating a national AI policy. The task force's chairman [stated](#) that the main areas of consideration were data privacy, security, and the ethical use of AI.



Peru

The Peruvian Government [issued](#) Peru's draft National Artificial Intelligence Strategy (ENIA) in 2021, outlining a strategy through 2026. However, the efforts to establish a formal national strategy stalled. In February 2024, lawmakers set forth [BoL 07033/2023](#) to establish a legal framework for AI use and regulation. Then, in May 2024, Peru's Presidency of the Council of Ministers released [a new draft AI regulation](#) for public comment to promote AI for economic and social development.



Uruguay

In 2019, Uruguay published its [National AI Strategy](#), which elaborates on the country's vision for the use of AI. The strategy outlines the government's four main pillars of governance, responsible use of AI, citizens and AI, and capacity-building. In June 2022, the Uruguayan government announced the establishment of an [Observatory of the Use of AI in the State](#) to promote transparency, enhance trust, and mitigate risks around the use of AI technologies.

In November 2024, Uruguay [approved](#) a revised National AI Strategy for 2024 through 2030 to promote the development of AI in the public and private sectors.



Australia

In November 2019, the Australian government published a [Roadmap for AI](#), which is intended to guide future AI investment. The Roadmap identifies three key areas where AI could transform Australian industries: health, aging, and disability; cities, towns, and infrastructure (including automated vehicle technology); and national resources and environment (especially mining and agriculture).

In August 2024, the Australian Government [introduced](#) the Voluntary AI Safety Standard and in September 2024, the Australian Government published a [proposals paper](#) for introducing mandatory guardrails for AI in high-risk settings. Effective September 2024, the Digital Transformation Agency [set out expectations](#) for AI use within the public sector. This policy is intended to demonstrate Australian Government leadership in embracing AI to benefit Australians responsibly.

Asia



Bangladesh

To make Bangladesh a “technologically advanced nation by the next decade,” Bangladesh published its [National Strategy on Artificial Intelligence](#) in March 2020. The plan has six pillars: 1) research and development, 2) skilling and reskilling of AI workforce, 3) data and digital infrastructure, 4) ethics, data privacy, security & regulations, 5) funding and accelerating AI startups, and 6) industrialization for AI technologies. In 2024, the Ministry of Posts, Telecommunications, and Information Technology [published](#) a revised National Artificial Intelligence policy, placing an emphasis on educating its citizens about AI.



China

China’s approach to AI regulation is unique because it focuses heavily on national security, economic development, and social stability. Given the centralized nature of China’s government, it has a strong role in shaping how AI is developed and used.

AI appears central to China’s vision to boost the economy and contribute as a leader in global technology. The country’s [New Generation Artificial Intelligence Development Plan](#) was among the first efforts to set out a top-level goal of global AI leadership by 2030. While China introduced regulations for [algorithmic recommendations](#) and [deep synthesis](#), the Generative AI Measures became necessary as AI development continued.

[The Generative AI Measures](#) aim to promote healthy development and regulated application of AI, as well as “safeguarding national security and social public interests.” The measures are only applicable to services accessible to the general public within China. In addition, the Generative AI Measures exclude generative AI services developed and utilized by enterprises, research and academic institutions, and other public entities from their scope. The government retains strict control over AI applications that affect social stability, such as facial recognition and surveillance.

The measures, along with the [Personal Information Protection Law](#), regulate how these models can handle citizens’ data. However, the government retains broad powers over data.



India

India has three main frameworks that regulate AI. First, the [National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence](#) was adopted in 2018 and aims to establish a basis for future AI regulation. Second, the [Principles for Responsible AI](#) was adopted in February 2021 and serves as a roadmap to establish an ethical, responsible AI ecosystem. Finally, the [Operationalizing Principles for Responsible AI](#) was adopted in August 2021 and emphasizes the need for regulatory interventions, capacity building, and incentivizing the ethical design of AI.



Indonesia

The [National Strategy for Artificial Intelligence](#) (Stranas KA) was published in August 2020. It aims to advance the Indonesian economy through 2045 with leadership in AI. Stranas KA outlines five national priorities for AI: health services, bureaucratic reform, education and research, food security, and services related to the Smart Cities Movement.

In 2023, the [Ministerial Circular Letter on AI Ethics](#) was released, which outlines guidelines on how to mitigate AI risks. On February 9, 2025, the ministry [indicated](#) that it was drafting a new regulation on AI that will add concrete guidance to their national AI strategy.



Japan

Japan has taken a collaborative and ethical approach to AI regulation, focusing on promoting AI in a beneficial and safe way for society. Japan was one of the first countries to [address social issues](#) in AI, such as healthcare, eldercare, labor shortages, rural depopulation, and public safety. Japan is sensitive to its aging population and is looking to AI to solve these problems. Thus, rather than strict law, Japan has largely taken a soft-law approach with ethical guidelines and frameworks so far.

No laws or regulations have been enacted that explicitly regulate AI. However, discussions are underway to establish such laws. On February 16, 2024, the ruling party's project team on the Evolution and Implementation of AI released the [rough draft of the AI Act](#), which proposes governance for "frontier AI models." Frontier models are high-performance, general-purpose AI models capable of performing a wide variety of tasks.

Japan is also working with international organizations, like the OECD, to create [global standards](#) for AI ethics. Japan wants its AI policies to [align](#) with other democracies, particularly the EU and the U.S. For example, Japan's social principles encourage companies to prioritize safety, transparency, and accountability, similar to the U.S. and EU guidelines.



Kazakhstan

In July 2024, the Minister of Digital Development, Innovations, and Aerospace Industry [announced](#) that Kazakhstan could have a new "Artificial Intelligence Law" in place by the first half of 2025. On February 5, 2025, the Majilis deputies of the Senate [adopted](#) the bill "On artificial intelligence" to establish a unified legal framework for the use of AI. Kazakhstan has also [adopted](#) a Concept for Artificial Intelligence Development for 2024-2029.



Malaysia

In September 2024, Malaysia [introduced](#) the National Guidelines on AI Governance and Ethics. Then, in December 2024, the government [established](#) a national AI office to shape policies and address regulatory issues in AI, with the goal of making Malaysia a regional hub for AI.



Philippines

The Philippines launched its AI strategy in 2021, with the goal of positioning itself as a data-processing hub that can provide data analytics and AI services on the global stage. Then, in July 2024, the government launched its [National AI Strategy Roadmap 2.0](#), incorporating recent technological advancements, including Generative AI.

On December 19, 2024, the National Privacy Commission issued Advisory [No. 2024-04](#) which outlines guidelines for AI development and deployment for systems that process personal data.



Singapore

Singapore first established an AI Governance Framework in 2019, which provided guidance for the public sector regarding ethical and governance issues. It was updated in [2020](#) and [2024](#). In 2024, the framework was updated to include Generative AI with the goal of fostering a comprehensive and trusted AI ecosystem.



South Korea

In December 2024, South Korea [passed](#) its first major AI legislation entitled The Act on the Development of Artificial Intelligence and Establishment of Trust (AI Basic Act). The act shows [similarities](#) to the EU AI Act, adopting a risk-based approach to AI regulation. It both promotes AI and places stricter regulations on systems. For example, the bill calls for the establishment of new data centers, but also creates new labeling requirements. The AI Basic Act will not be in enforcement until January 2026.



Thailand

Thailand's national [AI strategy and action plan](#) spans from 2022 until 2027. The plan outlines the need for additional infrastructure, human capacity, and effective ecosystems to enhance the economy and quality of life with AI.



Vietnam

In 2021, the government published its “[National Strategy on R&D and Application of Artificial Intelligence](#).” The Strategy outlines Vietnam's AI goals through 2030. The strategy focuses on becoming a leading hub in AI within the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) by planning investments in education, innovation, and infrastructure.

In February 2024, the government approved a [national data strategy](#) laying the groundwork for a domestic AI sector. Specifically, its objective is to create seamless connectivity for large data storage and high-performance computing across the country.

In January 2025, Vietnam's Ministry of Information and Communications [released](#) the latest version of its draft Law on the Digital Technology Industry, which is expected to be adopted in May 2025. This law would create a comprehensive regulation for digital technologies, including AI.

Africa



Ethiopia

In June 2024, Ethiopia implemented a [National AI policy](#) to position itself as Africa's AI development center by 2035. The plan reflects the African Union's AI objectives: infrastructure development; capacity building through education and human resource development; and establishing legal frameworks to promote ethical AI.



Kenya

In April 2024, The Kenya Bureau of Standards published the [Draft Information Technology Artificial Intelligence Code of Practice](#). The Code aims to help organizations develop and provide AI responsibly and human rights-consciously. In addition, Kenya developed the [National Digital Master Plan 2022-2032](#), which encouraged the increase of research and development in AI.

In January 2025, the Ministry of Information, Communications, and the Digital Economy published a [draft](#) of the Kenya national Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2025-2030 for public comment.



Mauritius

Mauritius was one of the first African countries to publish an AI strategy, announcing the [Mauritius Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#) in 2018. The strategy has three pillars: the creation of an AI ecosystem, support for increased adoption in the public sector, and support for increased adoption in the private sector.



Nigeria

In August 2024, Nigeria adopted its [National AI strategy](#). It features a roadmap for legal structures to support responsible AI development, strongly emphasizing regulatory frameworks and ethical AI.



Rwanda

The Cabinet of Rwanda approved their national AI policy on April 20th, 2023. The [National Artificial Intelligence Policy for the Republic of Rwanda](#) serves as a roadmap to enable Rwanda to harness the benefits of AI and mitigate its risks. The policy seeks to reskill the workforce, invest in university education, adapt Rwandan education to STEM skills, streamline student and professional exchanges, ensure access to strong storage and computing power, and increase the accessibility of AI-ready data.



South Africa

In April 2024, South Africa introduced a [Draft National Intelligence Plan](#). It was then formally [published](#) by the Department of Communications and Digital Technologies in October 2024 for a commenting period. The draft covers talent development, digital infrastructure, research, public sector implementation, ethical AI, data protection, safety and security, transparency, fairness, a human-centered approach, professional responsibility, and alignment with cultural values. On February 13, 2025, the government [indicated](#) the plan is still in the draft phase.



Trinidad and Tobago



In August 2022, the Ministry of Digital Transformation released a [draft national digital transformation strategy](#). The strategy had three pillars: digital society, digital government, and digital economy. A final plan has yet to be implemented.



Tunisia

The Tunisian government has implemented a national AI strategy, but the implementation was curtailed due to political instability. A new plan was then drafted. In 2022, a [memorandum](#) was signed to define the national AI strategy and follow up on the results of a study planned to establish it.

Tunisia has implemented [innovation hubs](#) to foster collaboration between academia and industry and educate the workforce.

Middle East



Azerbaijan

In February 2022, the Ministry of Economy of the Republic of Azerbaijan [announced](#) they would establish an AI Strategy. On January 31, 2025, Prime Minister Ali Asadov [reported](#) they are currently developing its national AI strategy. The Prime Minister highlighted their focus on priority sectors including health care, transportation, and education.



Bahrain

While the country has yet to formulate a national AI framework, Bahraini Prime Minister Prince Salman bin Hamad Al Khalifa [approved](#) the Sixth National Telecommunications Plan, which [includes](#) the development of a national AI strategy and monitoring mechanism, “collaborative AI governance,” “Conductive AI,” and AI “adoption across high-impact sectors.”

Parliament is set to review the formal version of the AI regulation [approved](#) by the [Shura Council](#) in the coming months. The regulation emphasizes privacy and protection against discrimination and includes prohibitions on AI use for political unrest or disturbances.



Egypt

Egypt issued its [National AI Strategy](#) in November 2021. The strategy's main objectives are to exploit AI technologies to achieve their sustainable development goals and facilitate regional cooperation in the African and Arab regions, with Egypt as an active international player in AI. The strategy consists of four pillars: 1) AI for government, 2) AI for development, 3) capacity building and 4) international activities.

Iran



In July 2024, Iran [established](#) the National AI Organization in addition to adopting a comprehensive National Strategy Document on AI.

The document emphasizes harnessing AI for governance, the digital economy, and entrepreneurship, as well as cultural values and international cooperation. The AI Organization is tasked with executing the AI initiative, fostering innovation, and creating economic growth. For [example](#), the organization is in charge of creating data line farms, developing large-scale software solutions, and compiling AI data for government use.

In January, President Pezeshkian [indicated](#) that his administration is working to develop more policies that facilitate AI development in Iran.

Israel



The Ministry of Innovation, Science and Technology published its "[Artificial Intelligence Regulations and Ethics](#)" policy in 2023. The government's policy focuses solely on private-sector AI innovation through non-binding principles and standards. The principle-based policy takes a sector-specific approach to regulation, with the potential for horizontal legislation if common issues arise. According to the policy, a policy on public sector application is being developed as a separate matter.

Qatar



Qatar's [National AI Strategy](#), adopted in 2019, focuses on six pillars: education, data access, employment, business, research, and ethics. Since then, Qatar's approach to AI regulations has reflected those of the United States and EU, likely to maintain cross-border trade and draw in foreign businesses. In December 2024, Qatar and the UK [announced](#) a joint AI commission to strengthen AI capabilities and develop policy.



Saudi Arabia

AI is a core pillar of Saudi Arabia's [Vision 2030](#). Sixty-six of the plan's ninety-six strategic objectives relate to AI and data. The Saudi Data and Artificial Intelligence Authority (SDAIA) developed the National Strategy for Data & AI, which hopes to stimulate the commercialization and industry application of data and AI.

In September 2023, the SDAIA issued its [AI Ethics Principles](#) (Version 1.0), which represents the first AI legal framework and AI ethics framework in Saudi Arabia.

In April 2023, the Saudi Authority for Intellectual Property (SAIP) [published a draft](#) set of amendments to intellectual property legislation for public consultation with a section on AI-related IP.



Türkiye

In 2020, the Turkish government's Digital Transformation Office (DTO) outlined a [National Artificial Intelligence Strategy](#). The strategy's primary objective was to promote the use of AI and big data in the public sector through a human-centered approach. The strategy was then [updated](#) in August 2021 to set goals between 2021 and 2025. The new strategy emphasizes respect for human rights, protecting the environment, ensuring diversity and inclusiveness, and living in interconnected societies.

The Turkish Personal Data Protection Authority has published a series of privacy guidelines concerning the implementation of AI solutions in different sectors, including limiting the use of personal data in [AI applications](#), [the banking sector](#), and [mobile applications](#).



United Arab Emirates

In 2017, the UAE became the first country in the world to appoint a Minister of State for Artificial Intelligence. Since then, the UAE has been actively issuing numerous AI-related regulations and guidelines. For example, the AI office has published guidelines for [deepfakes](#), [ethics](#), AI in [government services](#), and the [metaverse](#). In February, the UAE [published](#) a policy document on UAE's international stance on AI policy.

On July 30, 2024, the UAE announced a new [AI charter](#) to support its [AI strategy for 2031](#). The charter focuses on human-centered well-being, safety, privacy, and AI development and use transparency.